

growth. It is estimated that for every 1% nominal economic growth in Aspirational Districts, India's GDP can rise by up to ₹2 lakh crore.

Ensuring 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas', especially at the last mile, requires 'Sabka Prayaas' to achieve the SDGs by 2030.

ANALYSIS

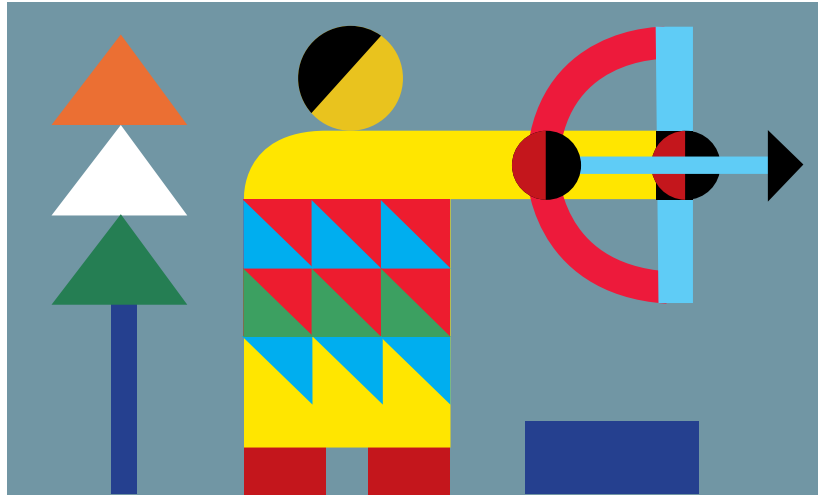
India has seen three distinctive philanthropic traditions—relief, improvement, and social reform. We are currently in the fourth evolution of philanthropy, which emphasises strategic, impactful initiatives. This crossroads asks a simple question—do we keep doing more of the same, which has been effective in reaching the top 50% of India and somewhat successful in reaching the third quartile, or should we evolve to ensure it benefits the bottom quartile equally?

44 | In the last 16 years, Piramal Foundation has worked closely with 170+ districts, 25 states, and 10+ central ministries. Despite substantial investments, change is often slow. This is primarily due to a focus on the 'events' of absence, negligence, or incompetence of specific officials, or the 'patterns' that emerge over time in how a department or ministry operates. To drive sustainable change, we must adopt a 'systems lens' approach, examining the underlying 'structures' and 'mental models' that influence these behaviours and outcomes.

Sustainable change is possible if we apply a systems thinking lens along with stronger collaborations between the government and the private sector to ensure inclusive and equitable growth for all.

RECOMMENDATION

Philanthropy and civil society, with collaborative efforts, can strengthen government delivery by targeting critical leverage points and deploying funds as catalytic capital.



Investments should focus on strengthening state capacities to execute large-scale, mission-driven initiatives effectively

Addressing the needs of the bottom quartile requires a concerted effort across several critical domains. We need to focus on education and ensure comprehensive, quality healthcare to improve overall outcomes. Sustainability initiatives should enhance the management of clean water sources and natural resources to support long-term well-being. Addressing gender and inclusion disparities will guarantee equitable opportunities and fair access. By integrating these strategies with a systematic approach, we can drive meaningful progress and create a more inclusive and equitable society.

By using over ₹40,000 crore from CSR and civil society investments (which is just 0.1% of government spending), we can boost the results of the government's ₹48 lakh crore-plus spending by 10%.

Investments should focus on

strengthening state capacities to execute large-scale, mission-driven initiatives effectively. This includes modernising processes through digitisation, decentralising decision-making for more localised governance, investing in leadership development to foster adaptive leaders, and prioritising inclusion to ensure all communities benefit equitably.

CONCLUSION

As we march towards the centenary of our Independence, we must ensure no one is left behind. The transformative curve needs to be driven by the spirit of 'Sewa Bhaav', instilling a shared commitment to uplift the bottom quartile. Our collective actions today, guided by systems thinking and strategic leadership, will shape India@100. **BT**

The author is Chairman, Piramal Group. Views are personal